Individual systematic forecast - method note

26 October 2026 | 334 words in the copy-ready method description

I forecast the 15 seat fields from reviewed, published seat projections available by 24 October 2026. For each of seven polling groups, I use its latest eligible release in a 14-day window, counting the end of fieldwork when known and otherwise the publication date. Each group has equal weight. I map complete published seat tables to the form's named fields before averaging; a missing vote percentage is not treated as zero.

I choose the integer seat vector that minimizes the sum of squared differences from those mean seats, with a total of 120 and each individual list assigned either zero or at least three seats. If vectors tie, I minimize absolute disagreement with the polls and then use a fixed field order. This rule excludes one- and two-seat outputs. The three seats assigned to Reservists-Economic are a compromise under these constraints, not a result reported by a single poll or a calibrated probability that it clears the threshold. Amcha Yisrael receives zero. I assign other qualifying lists individually before combining their seats in the form's final field; their current combined forecast is zero.

For turnout, I use the arithmetic mean of national turnout in the last three Knesset elections: 71.52%, 67.44%, and 70.63%. The mean is 69.86% to two decimal places. Historical backtests, regression and other model trials informed the choice of this simple rule, but did not establish a reliable improvement to the submitted seat or turnout forecasts. I did not add a war adjustment or learned poll-firm weights.

The current Joint List is mapped to the form field named Hadash-Ta'al as an explicit current-election assumption; past party identities remain separate. A separate Bader-Ofer allocator was checked against official 2022 results, but I do not apply it to the current prediction because complete current vote shares and verified surplus agreements are unavailable. The forecast uses published seat projections, not reconstructed vote counts. Source conflicts and official list and agreement verification remain open. Code, reviewed inputs, assumptions and outputs are linked in the repository.

Data sources

Reviewed published election polls and seat tables through 24 October 2026 (seven polling groups; source URLs and dates in data/snapshots/polls-2026-10-24.json); official Central Elections Committee national turnout results for the 2020, 2021 and 2022 Knesset elections (data/snapshots/turnout-history-2026-10-24/inputs.json). The current Joint List-to-Hadash-Ta'al form mapping is documented in config/poll-mappings.json.

https://github.com/Omer-Sut/israel-election-forecast

This is a prepared forecast, not a submitted form. Source verification remains incomplete.